



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Operations

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of operations.
2. Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.
3. Explain company selling policies.
4. Explain the relationship between customer service and distribution.
5. Discuss actions employees can take to achieve the company's desired results.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Operations Director for VANGUARD DENIM, an established women's apparel company specializing in high-end denim, outerwear, and accessories. You are meeting with the Vice President of Distribution (judge) to present the operational infrastructure for shifting to a "Showroom Hub" model.

VANGUARD DENIM operates 100 physical locations but is currently facing declining sales and increasing amounts of inventory that are not moving quickly enough from store shelves. To address these challenges, executives have approved the creation of "Showroom Hubs" (guideshops). These locations will feature only sample merchandise for trying on, eliminating the need to stock apparel for sale in the physical stores. Customers will work with a stylist ("Guide") and place their final orders at an onsite kiosk or online, with the merchandise being shipped directly to their homes.

This shift significantly impacts VANGUARD DENIM's distribution and inventory storage practices. While the company aims to cut costs with smaller stores and focus on customer service rather than inventory management, the Vice President of Distribution (judge) is concerned that without proper planning, the new centralized fulfillment system could lead to substantial distribution issues.

The Vice President of Distribution (judge) wants you to present an operational strategy focusing on the transition to the Showroom Hub model, specifically addressing the following:

- Explain the nature of warehousing required for this centralized distribution model, describing how inventory management changes when all sales are processed centrally rather than locally.
- Discuss current distribution issues and trends, particularly addressing the challenge of minimizing delivery time delays now that all orders must be shipped from a warehouse.
- Explain how information systems must be adapted to ensure immediate and reliable order fulfillment from the centralized warehouse, linking the in-store kiosk orders to warehouse operations effectively.
- Analyze how implementing the Showroom Hub model will significantly reduce overhead and operating costs and provide VANGUARD DENIM with a distinct competitive advantage.

You will present your operational plan to the Vice President of Distribution (judge) in a meeting to take place in their office. The Vice President will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented the analysis and have answered their questions, the Vice President will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How will the Showroom Hub model maintain a high level of customer satisfaction, especially for customers who prefer immediate product availability?
2. What potential challenges or risks do you foresee during the transition to the Showroom Hub model, and how would you mitigate them to ensure a smooth rollout?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of operations?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain company selling policies?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain the relationship between customer service and distribution?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Discuss actions employees can take to achieve the company's desired results?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						